

Pavel Bukengolts

Executive UX & Product Design Leader | Scaling Enterprise Platforms, Design Systems, and Delivery
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Summary

Executive UX and product design leader who turns fragmented platforms, inconsistent delivery, and operational drag into scalable systems that reduce cost, speed execution, and improve quality. Scaled an in-house design team from 1 to 10 people at Protective Life, then led distributed teams of up to 40 people across 4 global regions at Abbott while governing design systems across 800+ digital properties. Now operationalizing AI-assisted workflows at the UX Design Lab that cut client delivery timelines by up to 60%. Known for aligning design, engineering, and business teams around product and operating models that actually ship.

Career Highlights

- Scaled an in-house design organization from 1 to 10 people across 2 teams at Protective Life.
- Led distributed internal and vendor teams of up to 40 people across 4 global regions at Abbott, governing design systems across 800+ digital properties.
- Compressed client delivery timelines by 60% at the UX Design Lab by operationalizing AI across research, prototyping, and delivery.
- Drove a 30% lift in user engagement across healthcare, fintech, and SaaS client programs at DePalma Studios.

Core Competencies

Enterprise UX & Product Design Leadership • Product Strategy & Discovery • Design Operations • Design Systems • Accessibility & WCAG 2.2 • AI-Enhanced Workflows • Platform Modernization • Cross-Functional Leadership • Research & Data-Driven Design • Change Management

Experience

Head of Product Design & Strategy

UX Design Lab, LLC | *Nashville, TN*

04.2024 – Present

- Cut client delivery timelines by 60% by operationalizing AI-assisted workflows across research, prioritization, prototyping, and delivery while preserving human oversight and usability standards.
- Shaped product strategy and UX discovery for enterprise clients, clarifying ambiguous business problems and aligning stakeholders on direction before engineering begins.
- Reduced delivery risk for enterprise clients by building scalable design operating models and governance frameworks that sustain compliance, quality, and cross-functional execution after engagement.
- Shipped the Team Capability Engine MVP in under 90 days, directing 0-to-1 product strategy, design, AI-enabled workflows, and delivery to secure 3 beta pilots for market validation.

Lead of Enterprise Design Operations & Strategy

Abbott | *Remote*

01.2022 – 04.2024

- Cut production time by 40% and slashed vendor dependency costs by 50% by architecting and scaling a design system pipeline across 800+ digital properties.
- Unified distributed internal and vendor teams of up to 40 people across the U.S., LATAM, APAC, and EMEA through standardized Lean UX rituals, delivery handoffs, and governance workflows.
- Led rollout and change management for a cross-platform system integrating Figma, Storybook, and Adobe Experience Manager, replacing fragmented tooling with a single, governed product-delivery model.
- Reduced critical accessibility defects by 18% by embedding WCAG 2.2 compliance directly into the delivery pipeline through structured reviews and checklists, ensuring enterprise-wide audit readiness.

VP of User Experience and Web Management

Protective Life | *Remote*

01.2020 – 11.2021

- Cut departmental costs by 20% and improved team efficiency by 15% by implementing an end-to-end UX delivery framework covering intake, prioritization, KPIs, and execution.
- Modernized the customer experience across 70+ web properties by establishing a unified design system and standardizing multi-brand journeys to improve consistency and speed.
- Reduced developer dependency by 60% by embedding standardized design practices and accessibility protocols into product and engineering workflows.
- Scaled the design organization from a single contributor to a 10-person, two-team structure, creating a durable operating model for delivery and collaboration.

Director of User Experience

DePalma Studios | *Nashville, TN*

10.2017 – 01.2020

- Drove a 30% lift in user engagement by leading UX strategy, strategic prototyping, and disciplined design reviews across client programs.
- Increased team velocity by 25% by overhauling delivery pipelines with Lean UX, Agile frameworks, and standardized intake and prioritization.
- De-risked product decisions for clients in healthcare, fintech, and SaaS through prototyping and structured design leadership, reducing ambiguity before build.
- Led 3 distributed teams of up to 21 people across 3 countries, shaping engagements from discovery through delivery and raising accessibility maturity across distributed teams and vendors.

Senior HCI Engineer (Principal UX Designer)

Sitecore Inc.- Platform Innovation and Engineering | *Remote*

04.2013 – 08.2017

- Drove a 30% lift in user adoption by leading UX for platform personalization and advanced marketing applications inside Sitecore's innovation group.
- Shaped product direction as a principal-level IC, making interaction design, systems, and front-end architecture decisions that set the platform's experience strategy.
- Established foundational UX rules across the platform by auditing legacy systems and shipping a code-level proof of concept that became the architectural blueprint for visual design and engineering.

Industry Leadership, Publications & Mentorship

- Top 3 Finalist, Tech Educator of the Year, *Greater Nashville Technology Council Awards*
- Top 100 World's Most Influential Mentors, *ADPList*
- Contributing Author, *UX Magazine*, published articles on UX strategy, AI-enhanced workflows, accessibility, and design systems
- Adjunct Professor of UX, UI & AI, *Nossi College of Art & Design*

Education

Computer and Digital Communication Science | Master of Science

Belarus State University of Informatics and Electronics

Focus: Human Factors, Ergonomics

Graphic Design | Bachelor of Arts

School of Visual Arts

Skills

Strategy & Operations: UX and Product Design Strategy, Product Discovery, Design Leadership, DesignOps, System Governance, Service Design, Lean UX, Agile Delivery, Change Management

Research & Accessibility: Continuous Discovery, Information Architecture, WCAG 2.2 Compliance, Inclusive Design, Usability and Evaluative Research

AI & Delivery: AI-Assisted Workflows, Agentic AI Systems, AI Governance, Prompt Engineering, Applied AI

Tools: Figma, Sketch, Miro, UserTesting, Jira, Confluence